# DA Timer Help

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## What DA Timer does

DA Timer is a show timer for a broadcast Director's Assistant. It runs two clocks: a **segment** clock for the current item and a **program** clock for the whole show. It tells you whether you're over or under on each segment and in total.

It can also back-time to a hard out, keep a log of notes, mark times you can export to Excel, and put the clocks on a second screen for the presenter or floor. It runs on Windows and Mac, and can be driven from a Stream Deck.

## The main screen

The top card is the segment clock and the bottom card is the program clock. Each card's coloured bar on the left goes green when that clock is running.

| Button | What it does |
|---|---|
| ALL START / ALL STOP | Starts or stops both clocks together |
| START / STOP (on a card) | Starts or stops just that clock |
| NEXT (segment card) | Ends the current segment, records its time in the running order, and starts the next one from zero |
| RESET (program card) | Clears both clocks and the segment times, ready for a new show (asks first; Undo brings it back) |
| PRESET | Types in a time, e.g. if you started late; works while the clock is running |

Under each clock, the goal and “left” or “over” readout turns amber in the last 15 seconds of a segment and red once it's over. The toolbar along the bottom opens everything else.

## Features

Each of these is in the toolbar, and you can switch off any you don't need in **Settings**.

| Feature | What it's for |
|---|---|
| **Running order** | Lists each segment with its goal, actual time, +/− and start-by time |
| **Goals & hard out** | Set a goal for each segment (or paste them from Excel), how many segments the show has (for "segments left"), and a hard out: an off-air time or a total program length |
| **Back-timing** | With a hard out set, a band shows time to out, projected length and how much to cut or spare |
| **Log** | Type a note (the time is stamped when you start typing) or press Mark; each entry records the time of day and program time. **Export to Excel** saves it |
| **Clock** | Shows the time of day in the header |
| **Output to monitor** | Puts a clean full-screen clock display on a second monitor for the presenter or floor, with "Segment 3 of 8 · 5 left" and an optional time-of-day or timecode clock. The ▾ next to Output to monitor picks the monitor, and Layout, sizes and colours chooses what shows, how big, what colour and in what order, per show. The segment clock there can count down to its goal, then up in red when over. The mouse pointer hides on the output after 2 seconds. For a video overlay instead of a monitor, the same ▾ → Video overlay (OBS / vMix) gives an address to add as a browser source (1920 × 1080): a transparent timing bar along the bottom of the picture |
| **Show** | Saves each show's name, logos, titles and colours, so you can switch between shows |
| **Stream Deck** | Plug a Stream Deck in and DA Timer drives it directly. Or use the Elgato plugin |
| **Time source** | Uses the computer clock, network time (NTP) or LTC timecode from an audio input |
| **Undo** | Undoes the last action, including an accidental reset, without losing time on the clocks |

While a clock runs, DA Timer keeps the computer from sleeping or blanking the screen. If it closes unexpectedly mid-show, it offers to restore the clocks and log when you reopen it.

## Keyboard shortcuts

Single-key shortcuts don't fire while you're typing a note, and can be switched off in Settings.

| Key (Windows) | Key (Mac) | Does |
|---|---|---|
| Space | Space | Start / stop both clocks |
| N | N | Next segment |
| D | D | Output to monitor on / off |
| L | L | Running order on / off |
| T | T | Time-of-day clock on / off |
| G | G | Goals & hard out |
| F2 | F2 (fn+F2) | Type a log note |
| Ctrl+M | Cmd+M | Log a mark |
| Ctrl+Z | Cmd+Z | Undo |
| Ctrl+, | Cmd+, | Settings |
| F11 / Esc | fn+F11 / Esc | Full screen GUI on / off (or the Full screen GUI button) |

## First launch on a Mac

macOS blocks DA Timer the first time because it isn't signed with a paid Apple developer certificate. Allow it once per Mac, and again after each new version. You'll need the Mac's login password or Touch ID.

1. Drag **DA Timer.app** into **Applications**, then double-click it. When the "Not Opened" warning appears, click **Done** (not Move to Trash).
2. Open **System Settings** → **Privacy & Security**.
3. Scroll down to **Security**. Next to **"DA Timer" was blocked to protect your Mac**, click **Open Anyway**.

4. In the next warning, click **Open Anyway** again.
5. Enter your password or use Touch ID. DA Timer opens, and opens normally from then on.

If **Open Anyway** isn't there, double-click DA Timer again, then go back to Privacy & Security. The button only appears for a while after a blocked attempt.